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ANNUAL REPORT



Coodu Trust, Dindigul



Registered / Head Office

Annual Report

From the Director's Desk

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Annual reports traditionally look back. And this one indeed highlights Coodu Trust's achievements and work over the past year. But I also want to look forward, especially as the clock ticks down towards the 2015 deadline for the Millennium Development Goals. Our sights and our efforts are focused on the future, and our commitment to young people is a linchpin in this respect. Today's young rural people are tomorrow's farmers, business people and leaders. Investment in their education, their abilities and their options is the best investment in the future of us all.

Coodu Trust is working towards : a rural sector in which young women and men live interesting, fulfilling lives while providing the food that will be needed. Today's young generation is the largest ever with more than 1 billion human beings aged 15 to 24. In developing countries, they make up about 20 per cent of the population. In rural areas many of them are growing up on smallholder farms. If they get the support they need to run those farms like small businesses - training, secure land tenure, credit, access to new technologies and environmentally sustainable methods - many will choose to say. Others will also opt to remain if decent jobs are available off the farm in the enterprises and business support services that make up a thriving local economy.

Poor rural people and their partners face challenges on every side. But challenges force us to focus and they also open new opportunities. We know that smallholder agriculture can lead economic growth in developing countries and lift millions out of poverty. But it has to be market - oriented, profitable and environmentally sustainable. Climate change is with us to stay, and farmers in the developing world must be enabled to adapt to it and to contribute to its mitigation.

I am convinced that much of the progress towards eradicating poverty and hunger will come in India that have given subsistence farmers the tools and the means to transform themselves into proud, self - sufficient, small - scale entrepreneurs.

S.JAGADEESAN
DIRECTOR, Coodu Trust

Genesis and Growth

Coodu Trust emerged in year 2000 based on the motivation of a few young and dynamic like minded persons and professionals who pledged to do efficient, constructive and everlasting social development work for the under privileged of the society to develop self sufficient and self reliant communities. The name 'Coodu' signifies 'Nest' – a place of rest, comfort and security for those in search of the same. Coodu trust is a not for profit voluntary organization to undertake charitable, educational and development activities for the welfare of downtrodden and marginalized needy people of society, including of fourteen districts of Tamil Nadu on watershed programmes and all the thirty districts for various social development work.

Over the years Coodu Trust emerged as one of the leading NGO in watershed development activities in Tamil Nadu especially on community organization and training programmes and research and documentation on various rural development issues. However we have decided in year 2006, to move on to two types of activities, Intensive grassroots activities in selected villages and districts and Technical and support services to development activities wherever needed. We have decided to work intensively among the communities on specific issues affecting them. We have selected Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Tiruchirappali and Kancheepuram districts for such intensive community development work including, Livelihood, women development, micro credit, health care, sanitation, environment, agriculture, HIV/AIDS and other activities addressing specific local problems for the following years.

Vision

"Creating an egalitarian, self-reliant society by adopting latest and appropriate technologies sustained through participatory community efforts"

Mission

The Mission of Coodu Trust is to create an egalitarian society thereby reducing disparity between classes through a gender-based and human rights approach. It seeks to create a self-reliant society by harnessing use of Information Technology enhancing productivity, speed, accountability and thereby overall efficiency in project management. It also seeks to build relationships within communities by adopting participatory methods, ensuring that the benefits of development reach 'the disadvantaged and marginalized'.

THRUST AREA

- ➔ Improve the overall socio, economic conditions of the poor, needy and disadvantageded communities.
- ➔ Undertake need based, people oriented, research and action based programmes in various developmental issues.
- ➔ Conceptualize, identify, design, train and implement various developmental projects to improve the livelihoods of different communities.
- ➔ Engage in the promotion of sustainable agriculture and rural development.
- ➔ Foster development education in different sectors and create awareness on various social problems.
- ➔ Provide consultancy services in project design, management and evaluation of developmental projects

Board of Trustees

Sl.No	Name	Qualification	Office held
1	Mr. S. Jagadeesan	B.Sc., MBA,	Managing Trustee
2	Ms. B. Hemachitra	M.Sc., B.Ed.,	Committee Member
3	Mr. C.T.V. Chidambara Kumar	B.Com,	Committee Member
4	Mr. S. Raja	B.A.,	Committee Member
5	Ms. P. Mahalakshmi	M.Sc., M.Phil,	Committee Member
6	Mr. D. Srinivasan	M.Sc., M.Phil, B.Ed.,	Committee Member
7	Mr. K. Samidurai	M.Sc.,	Committee Member
8	Ms. S. Rani	M.A.,	Committee Member

Rashtriya Mahila Kosh (RMK)

The National Credit Fund for Women or the Rashtriya Mahila Kosh (RMK) is working exclusively for poor women. Its loans are available solely and entirely to this target group. The reasons for this are several:

- Among the poor, the poor women are the most disadvantaged - they are characterized by lack of education and access to resources, both of which are required to help them work their way out of poverty and for upward economic and social mobility.
- The problem is more acute for women in countries like India, despite the fact that women's labour makes a critical contribution to the economy - this is due to low social status and lack of access to key resources.

Evidence shows that groups of women are better customers than men - they are better managers of resources - benefits of loans are spread wider among the household if loans are routed through

women - mixed groups are often inappropriate in Indian society - record of all-male groups is worse than that of all-women groups, everywhere.

It develops the supply side of the micro finance market by offering institution building support to new and existing-but-inexperienced IMOs by structures of incentives, transfers of technology, training of staff and other non-financial services. The Kosh realizes that it can play a value adding wholesaling role only when a sufficiently large and well established micro finance sector already exists - this depends on the number of IMOs and the sustainability of IMOs - subsidized institution building increases the equity of any IMO as much as grants do - large and premature disbursement of funds to the IMO can reduce the effectiveness of any institution building effort.

In RMK project our organization, Coodu Trust, had provided 50 milch animals for fifty women beneficiaries on loan. Three petty shops loan and ten number of educational loans were enhanced for the beneficiaries of Kadavur Block of Karur district in this year.

Targeted Intervention Migrants Project

Coodu Trust implemented Targeted Intervention Program for migrant workers in Karur, Thanthoni, Krishnarayapuram, Kadavur blocks of Karur District with the funding support of AIDS Prevention and Control Project (APAC- VHS). Migrant workers who have considerable numbers staying in Karur District are subject to vulnerable to STI and HIV/AIDS. Through this project, Coodu Trust intervened with the migrant workers with STI and HIV/AIDS prevention and control information and to create safer behavior practices among them towards HIV/AIDS. Under this project, the mi-

grants who engage in brick chambers, textile industries, dying industries, construction works and crushing points, seasonal agricultural works were covered. The major activities with the target groups under this project were one-one education, one-group education, counseling for the high risk groups, referral services for ICTC Centers, STI clinics and ART centres, organize STI camps at the migrant workplaces, identification and promotion of voluntary peer leaders (VPLs), condom promotion etc., All

these activities are managed with a Project Co-ordinator, 1 Counsellor and 6 outreach workers. In this year, 6512 high risk migrant workers (HRMw) were reached through this project in Karur district, out of which 4232 were in regular contact.

Mahalir thittam Project

Coodu Trust is being supported by Mahalir thittam project, with a main objective of providing and promoting micro-credit among poor women for income generation activities or for asset creation. As far as the micro-finance and micro insurance programs are considered, this is a foremost focusing on providing savings and credit services only. A range of other financial services including insurance and other support services were provided along with savings and credit services. The programmes of women development were performed towards creating or reorienting democratic, economic and social processes to enable poor women to participate

fully and actively in decision-making in the family and community level. As we are the approved NGO for Mahalir Thittam in Karur district of Tamil Nadu, the programmes were oriented to emphasis the empowerment of women to work together with men as equal partners and to inspire a new generation of women and men to work together for equality, sustainable development, and communal harmony.

We are performing this programme among the Women Self Help Group by demonstrating and replicating participatory approaches women's groups for thrift and savings with effective utilization of credit. In this programme Entrepreneurship train-

ings were imparted on Dairy development to 52 number of women beneficiaries, 47 number of women beneficiaries were trained on tailoring, likewise skill trainings were imparted on nursery management, vermicomposting and mushroom production to 27, 32 and 43 number of women SHG beneficiaries respectively.

Monitoring the convergence of programmes with NREGS with the financial assistance of UNDP

This programme was carried out with an objectives:

- To ensure the convergence between rural development and other departments for asset creation.
- To provide a key strategies for district level planning through bottom up approach.

Monitoring convergence activities of NREGS with the questionnaire, FDG, Participatory Impact Monitoring and Assessment will be entered in the data then and there in the district itself. Intra and inter-district comparison would be provoked using cumulative frequency, to highlight models, practices for replication. Based on the diagnosis, in-depth qualitative using participatory methodology and by quantitative analysis remedial action for future interventions might be framed. Convergence monitoring

of the durable assets created and value addition to assets created under NREGS through convergence for Sustainable livelihood, Physical assets created (e.g. length of road, size of a tank), Enduring outcomes (e.g. area irrigated, villages connected), Increase in cultivable area, Improved irrigation potential, Increased ground water recharge, Efficient use of irrigation system, Production and productivity of the standing crops. Participatory Impact Monitoring and Assessment with the participation of all the stakeholders involved in the convergence of NREGS viz., Wage seekers, Gram Sabha, PRIs, specially the gram panchayat, Officer at the block level and District Programme Coordinator at village level, block level and district level.

Bamboo cultivation

Field performance of micro and macro-propagated planting stock of selected five commercially important Bamboo species had been demonstrated at Vellayanai village of Thanthoni block in Karur district with collaboration with **Institute of Forest Genetics and Tree Breeding, Coimbatore**. Trail of IFGTB was established for three species namely *Dendrocalamus strictus*, *Pseudoxystenantha stocksii* and *Bambusa bambos* in an area of 10 acres with 28 different varieties. Growth performance of the tissue culture raised plants is being assessed with the seedling raised plants in this year

Tuberculosis Day

In this era of increasing access to antiretroviral therapy, it is unacceptable that tuberculosis remains among the commonest causes of illness and death in people living with HIV.

Even though TB is preventable and curable it continues to claim the lives of half a million people living with HIV each year. The HIV community cannot stand by and let this happen. Left unchecked TB and drug resistant TB - which knows no borders - could spread and become an even more severe global health threat.

The world has already committed to reducing new TB cases and deaths under Millennium Development Goal 6. However, I call on the HIV community to go one step further: We must commit to halving TB deaths in people living with HIV by 2015. UNAIDS is firmly committed to achieving this goal through the Joint Outcome Framework. Let us join hands with the TB community to raise awareness of TB among people living with HIV, strengthen joint community responses to HIV and TB and increase access to the most effective and integrated TB prevention, diagnostic and treatment services for people living with HIV. We can do much more to stop TB. We can stop people living with HIV from dying of TB. On this World TB Day I call on all our partners to make a pledge – halve TB deaths in people living with HIV by 2015 and bring hope to millions of people. We can stop people living with HIV from dying of TB. On this World TB Day I call on all our partners to make a pledge – halve TB deaths in people living with HIV by 2015 and bring hope to millions of people.

World Water Day

Theme : Clean water for a healthy world

The international observance of World Water Day is an initiative that grew out of the 1992 United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED) in Rio de Janeiro. The theme for the year 2010 is "Clean water for a healthy world"

More than 70% of our planet is filled with water. But fresh water constitutes a very small proportion of this enormous quantity. About 2.7 per cent of the total water available on the earth is fresh water of which about 75.2 per cent lies frozen in Polar Regions and another 22.6 per cent is present as ground water. The rest is available in lakes, rivers, atmosphere, moisture, soil We need anywhere between 30-50 liters of clean and safe water every day and yet 884 million people, lack access to safe water supplies.

Every year, 1,500 cubic kilometres of waste water are produced globally. While waste and wastewater can be

reused productively for energy and irrigation, it usually is not. In developing countries 80 percent of all waste is being discharged untreated, because of lack of regulations and resources. And population and industrial growth add new sources of pollution and increased demand for clean water to the equation. Human and environmental health, drinking and agricultural water supplies for the present and future are at stake, still water pollution rarely warrants mention as a pressing issue.



Women's Day

International Women's Day (8 March) is an occasion marked by women's groups around the world. This date is also commemorated at the United Nations and is designated in many countries as a national holiday. When women on all continents, often divided by national boundaries and by ethnic, linguistic, cultural, economic and political differences, come together to celebrate their Day, they can look back to a tradition that represents at least nine decades of struggle for equality, justice, peace and development.

Coodu trust celebrated the Women's Day function on 8th March 2010, with a rally encompassing the theme of "Women Empowerment" with a participation of nearly 2000 women members from 500 SHGs. The function of successful with the due participation of special delegates viz., Project Director (Mahalir Thittam) of Karur District, Block Development Officers and Bank Managers from Kadavur and Thogamalai Blocks, of Karur, Elected Representatives from all village panchayats.

World AIDS day

The theme for World AIDS Day 2009 was '*Universal Access and Human Rights*'. Global leaders have pledged to work towards universal access to HIV and AIDS treatment, prevention and care, recognizing these as fundamental human rights. Valuable progress has been made in increasing access to HIV and AIDS services, yet greater commitment is needed around the world if the goal of universal access is to be achieved. Millions of people continue to be infected with HIV every year. In India, less than half of those in need of antiretroviral therapy are receiving it, and too many do not have access to adequate care services.

The protection of human rights is fundamental to combating the global HIV and AIDS epidemic. Violations against human rights fuel the spread of HIV, putting marginalized groups, such as injecting drug users and sex workers, at a higher risk of HIV infection. By promoting individual human rights, new infections can be prevented and people who have HIV can live free from discrimination.

As World AIDS Day provides an opportunity for all of us - individuals, communities and political leaders - to take action and ensure that human rights are protected and global targets for HIV/AIDS prevention, treatment and care are met; Coodu trust celebrated the same with the focal theme on 1st Dec 2009 with the participation of 500 respondents from Karur district. The participation encompassed with affected and non affected persons. The programme was conducted at Bharath Petroleum Campus of Karur district. The programme was conducted with the Presidential address of Joint Director Health and the special address was delivered by the Director of District Youth Coordinator, during the occasion. The programme was a great success of the year.

National Youth Day

National Youth Day is celebrated in India on 12th January on the birthday of Swami Vivekananda. In 1984, the Government of India declared and decided to observe the birthday of Swami Vivekananda (12th January, according to the English calendar) as a National Youth Day every year from 1985 onwards. To quote from the Government of India's communication, 'it was felt that the philosophy of Swamiji and the ideals for which he lived and worked could be a great source of inspiration for the Indian Youth.'

The National Youth Day was conducted for Youth group of Karur District, with processions, speeches, recitations, music, youth conventions, seminars, competitions in essay-writing, recitations and sports on 12th January 2010, presided by the NYK District Coordinator of Karur district. About 150 rural youth participated and during this occasion the winners were provided with good awards and prizes. The same was celebrated with the participation of 200 rural youth in Dindigul district in collaboration with Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural Institute with the focal theme of Entrepreneurial Development of rural youth.

Migrants Day

Throughout human history, migration has been a courageous expression of the individual's will to overcome adversity and to live a better life. Today, globalization, together with advances in communications and transportation, has greatly increased the number of people who have the desire and the capacity to move to other places.

This new era has created challenges and opportunities for societies throughout the world. It also has served to underscore the clear linkage between migration and development, as well as the opportunities it provides for co-development, that is, the concerted improvement of economic and social conditions at both origin and destination. As Coodu Trust is privileged with a project of "Targeted Intervention for Migrants" at Karur District from TANSACS, we conducted and convened Migrants Day function on 18th Dec 2009 at Textile city at Manalmedu village in Kadavur block of Karur District with a participation of 1200 number of migrants from different states and different districts of Tamil Nadu to Karur District for better jobs.

Children's day

Children's day, in hindi known as "Bal Diwas", in India falls on November 14th every year and for good reason. Children's day in India is celebrated on Pandit Nehru's birthday as a day of fun and frolic, a celebration of childhood, children and Nehruji's love for them. As a tribute to this great man and his love for the children, his birthday is celebrated all over India as 'CHILDREN'S DAY'. Most schools have cultural programmes for the day, with the students managing it all. All over the country, various cultural, social, and even corporate, institutions conduct competitions for children. Children's Day is a day for children to engage in fun and frolic. Schools celebrate this day by organizing cultural programmes. Teachers of the school perform songs and dances for their students. Therefore, Children's Day is special occasion, which was celebrated in Dindigul District on 14th November 2009 in collaboration with Mid Town Rotary club of Dindigul with the participation of 300 children approximately with competition viz, competitions in essay-writing, drawing, fancy dress, recitations, sports etc. It is a day set aside to remember Pandit Nehru and his love for children.

Cancer Day

Cancer is a leading cause of death around the world, according to WHO, which estimates that 84 million people will die of cancer between 2005 and 2015 without intervention. Low-income and medium-income countries are harder hit by cancer than the high-resource countries. It is essential to address the world's

growing cancer burden and to work on effective control measures. World Cancer Day is part of the World Cancer Campaign, which responds to the Charter of Paris adopted at the World Summit Against Cancer for the New Millennium on February 4, 2000. It called for a strong alliance between researchers, health-care professionals, patients, governments, industry partners and the media to fight cancer. The Charter of Paris designated February 4 each year as World Cancer Day. UICC is responsible for coordinating World Cancer Day globally. It receives support from various partners and organizations, including the World Health Organization, the International Atomic Energy Agency, and other international bodies. UICC organized the first World Cancer Day in 2006. There are different symbols that are used to help promote the fight against different types of cancers. For example, the pink ribbon is a global symbol of breast cancer awareness, while the orange ribbon is associated with child cancer awareness.

Watershed programmes

Small and marginal farmers and landless agricultural labourers, Farm women and Rural youth were benefited with an objective of conservation, development and sustainable management of natural resources including, enhancement of agricultural productivity and production in a sustainable manner, Restoration of ecological balance in the degraded and fragile rainfed ecosystems by greening these areas through appropriate mix of trees, shrubs and grasses. Reduction in regional disparity between irrigated and rainfed areas. Creation of sustained employment opportunities for the rural community including landless labourers. Enhancement of the average income of small and marginal farmers and landless families through increased casual employment on marketable surplus of agricultural and dairy produce and by growing cash crops like vegetables. So skill oriented trainings were imparted to SHG's, UG's and Watershed Committee members on latest agricultural technologies. A participatory, outcome and impact-oriented and user-focused Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning system was undertaken for improvements in planning, project design and implementation. The watershed approach as a vehicle for transfer of rainfed agriculture technologies were monitored and evaluated regularly by WDT members for harmonious development of rain fed areas through involvement of the watershed community. Restoration of ecological balance. Employment generation, Ensured cropping intensity in rainfed agriculture. Improved protection of the tableland and stabilization of gullies.

Tamilnadu Health System Project (TNHSP)- Mortuary van service

The Economically weaker section, Rural peoples were served with an objective of improving the service delivery particularly for the poor, disadvantaged and tribal groups. Development of effective protocols to address key health challenges including Non Communicable Diseases (NCDs) & Road Traffic Accidents (RTA), improved oversight and system management, Public Sector service efficiency measures. The mortuary service was provided at affordable cost for targeted marginalized and SC/ST beneficiaries of the targeted district. The mortuary van service of our organization with the financial assistance of health department continued its service and winded the service in this year. Now we are charging, very low affordable cost of Rs.7/- per kilometer on kilometer basis, for one way, just to manage the system. More than 523 number of people were rendered the service of Mortuary van at affordable cost this year. The above said service is being fully rendered and dedicated to the needy poor's. To increase the access and utilization of health services, particularly for poor, disadvantaged, and tribal groups, next year onwards we have decided to render mortuary van service at free of cost to the orphan dead bodies.

Engagement of CAPART Young Professionals

The Young Professional (YP), scheme was introduced in CAPART in 1988 with the main objective of inducting professionalism in the development sector. In order to encourage professionalism in the Voluntary Sectors, CAPART makes campus recruitment each year from reputed Institutions like IRMA, TISS, IIFM, DSSW etc. and de-putes the recruits to work with Voluntary Organisation(s) (VO) and CAPART's own offices. On line in this aspect, 3 women CAPART Young Professionals were engaged in our organisation. They were engaged in the NABARD Programmes, UNDP Programme and CAPART Baseline survey works and in Group Mobilisation.

Advisory Board

Sl.No.	Name	Qualification	Designation
1.	Shri.C.R. Gunashekar	B.B.A, PGDM (IIPM),	Consultant, UNAIDS (Geneva), UNDP, FHI, New Delhi.
2.	Dr. S.K. Gopal	Ph.D.,	Programme Coordinator, Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural University, Gandhigram.
3.	Dr. P.J. Pandian	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Professor, Agronomy, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Killikulam.
4.	Dr. Porchezian	M.VSc, Ph.D.,	Professor and Head, UVTRC, Rajapalayam.
5.	Dr.(Mrs). Girija Prabu	M.B.B.S.,	Health Consultant, Karur.
6.	Mr. C.P. Chandra ban Singh	B.Sc (Agri), M.B.A.,	Consultant, Deputy Director (Agri) (Rtrd),
7.	Dr. P.N. Ananth	M.Sc (Agri), Ph.D.,	General Manager & Senior Consultant, Ana Horna Contique Consultants, Near Imperial Hotel, Gerji, Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.
8.	Mr. P.P. Saravanan	M.Sc., (Forestry)	SMS Agro Forestry, Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural University, Gandhigram.
9.	Mr. P. Venkatesan	M.Sc., (Agri), M.B.A.	SMS Agri. Extn, Krishi Vigyan Kendra, Gandhigram Rural University, Gandhigram.
10.	Mr. Ananth	M.A., (Sociology)	Project Coordinator, MSSRF, Sempatty, Dinidgul.
11.	Mr. Rama Pandian,	B.Sc., D.Pharm, D.M.L.T	President, Tamil Nad Network of Positive People (TNP+) &, Former President, Indian Network of Positive People (INP+)
12.	Mrs. C. Thilagavathy	+2	Chairman, Serukudi Watershed Committee, Serukudi, Tiruchy Dist.
13.	Mr. T. Ramaiyah	S.S.L.C	Farmer, Mavelipatty.
14.	Mrs. Saroja	+2	Secretary, Tharagampatti SHGs Federation, Karur Dist.

Contact Details

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